maintain, and there are many useful metrics that can be more easily tracked and visualized if the tasks are recorded electronically.

Because of these constraints, some teams prefer to keep track of work in some sort of issue-tracking or agile project-management system, even if they still use a physical board for day-to-day organization and visibility. Some practitioners refer to this as a "digital product backlog."[1] A digital product backlog can save you time and effort by calculating and reporting burn-down charts and other metrics automatically. It's also easier to attach extra information to a card without cluttering up the board.

In this situation, a team member (for example, the scrum master in a scrum team) will typically update the digital product backlog items based on the outcomes of the daily meeting around the physical board.

Storing user stories in an electronic system also has a number of advantages when it comes to integrating with BDD tools. In the simplest form, this integration may just include links to the corresponding card in the agile project-management software.

But a well-integrated system can do more. The BDD reporting tool can retrieve information from the digital product backlog and integrate this information into the reports. For example, the narrative description of a story need only be recorded in the digital product backlog and doesn't need to be duplicated in the feature file. A good reporting tool will be able to, at a minimum, add links in the living documentation to the corresponding items in the digital product backlog.

The simplest way to integrate scenarios with a digital product backlog is to use tags. Features and user stories are captured in the product backlog tool, where they have a unique number. The acceptance criteria are stored in the form of BDD feature files. Within these feature files, you use a specific tag to indicate the number of the corresponding item in the product backlog. For example, Thucydides uses the `@issue` tag for this purpose; if this tag is present, Thucydides will fetch the narrative text from the electronic product backlog and add a link to the corresponding item in the generated reports. This approach is illustrated in figure 11.7.

Reporting tools like Thucydides can also look up information about how the user stories are organized (in terms of epics, features, capabilities, and so forth). Some teams even update the status of the cards in the issue-tracking system based on the outcomes of the automated acceptance criteria, so if an acceptance criterion fails, the status of the corresponding card will be updated and the team notified.

11.4 Organizing the living documentation

If it's to be useful to the team as a whole, living documentation needs to be presented in a way that's easy to understand and navigate. For large projects, a flat list of features can quickly become unwieldy. Fortunately, there are many ways to structure living documentation so that it's easier to navigate and, as a result, is more valuable. Here, we'll look at two of the most common approaches:

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[1] This is the term we'll use going forward, because it's a lot easier to say than "agile project-management software."